

The final frontier

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Asixth World Cup appearance. One final shot. Cristiano Ronaldo is the proud owner of a seemingly endless catalogue of goals and a trophy cabinet bursting at the seams, but the centrepiece is still missing.

This will be the final opportunity for this generation's greatest goalscorer to crown his legacy with a World Cup triumph.

Portugal has long been an enigma on football's biggest stage. The nation has consistently produced players of immense talent, yet it has rarely managed to become greater than the

sum of its parts. That will be Roberto Martinez's biggest challenge as he leads his side to North America.

Portugal boasts one of the strongest midfields in the tournament in Bruno Fernandes, Vitinha and Joao Neves. Bernardo Silva, who operates in a deeper role for Manchester City, is often deployed on the right wing for his country, a move that could prove counterproductive given the modest club seasons endured by Portugal's wide attackers. Even so, there is enough pace and trickery out wide to make a significant impact from the bench when required.

In Qatar four years ago, Ronaldo had



PORTUGAL

FIFA Ranking: 5

Appearances: 8

Best finish: Third place (1966)

Matches: 35

Wins: 17

Draws: 6

Losses: 12

Goals For: 61

Goals Against: 41

Highest scorer in the squad
Cristiano Ronaldo (**143 goals**)



COLOMBIA

FIFA Ranking: 13

Appearances: 6

Best finish: Quarterfinal (2014)

Matches: 22

Wins: 9

Draws: 3

Losses: 10

Goals For: 32

Goals Against: 30

Highest scorer in the squad
James Rodriguez (**31 goals**)

